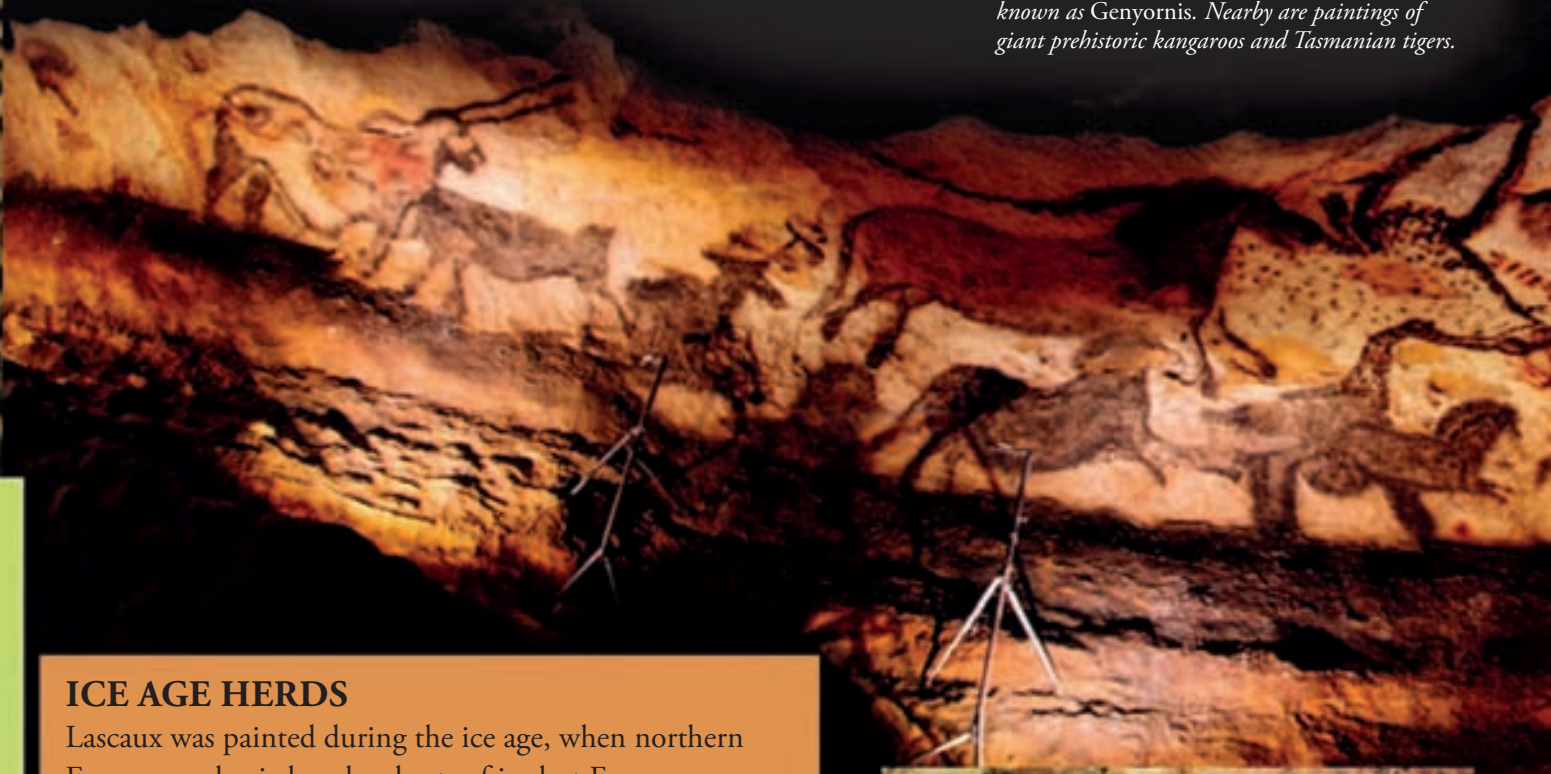


# Cave paintings

In September 1940, four teenage boys set out to try and find a secret passageway rumored to exist near their French village. What they discovered was a cave system decorated with hundreds of paintings of prehistoric animals. They'd found the 17,000-year-old Lascaux cave paintings, now famous the world over.



▲ **KILLER BIRDS** *This rock art in northern Australia is thought to be more than 40,000 years old. It shows two giant, flesh-eating, flightless birds known as Genyornis. Nearby are paintings of giant prehistoric kangaroos and Tasmanian tigers.*



## ICE AGE HERDS

Lascaux was painted during the ice age, when northern Europe was buried under sheets of ice but France was a treeless, windswept tundra, crossed by huge herds of wild animals. The people who painted the cave were hunters, but, oddly, they didn't paint their favorite prey—caribou.



◀ **ON THE RUN** *Stags (left) and horses are among the most common animals in Lascaux. Many appear to be moving, as though running in herds. Such animals migrated across the tundra during the last ice age, just as caribou do today.*



## Beautiful bison

Cave painters used a mineral called red ochre to color many of the animals. This picture shows a European bison, a species that later disappeared from western Europe but is now being reintroduced.

